LST-P3 · PRÁCTICA 03

Interview or conversation

Hoja 03 · Propósito, acuerdo parcial y actitud global · dificultad 3 de 4

5 preguntas (16–20) · 1 punto por pregunta · audio: LST-P3_Practica_03.mp3 · la grabación suena dos veces, con las pausas del examen · sin consultar la teoría

You will hear part of a radio programme in which the historian Martin Hale and the novelist Grace Okonjo discuss historical fiction. For questions 16–20, choose the answer (**A, B, C** or **D**) which fits best according to what you hear.

16 Why does Martin mention the letter he received last year?

A to show how strongly some readers object to inaccurate novels
B to illustrate his concern that readers confuse fiction with fact
C to admit that he had been mistaken about a historical detail
D to suggest that novelists should consult historians more often

17 What does Grace reveal about the mistake a reviewer found in one of her novels?

A She had included it on purpose.
B She corrected it when the book came out in paperback.
C It came from a source she should not have trusted.
D She felt the reviewer had misunderstood the scene.

18 What does Martin think novelists should do?

A avoid inventing events that are not recorded
B make clear which parts of their story are invented
C ask historians to check their work before publication
D remove any errors when their books are reprinted

19 Grace and Martin agree that historical novels

A often give characters attitudes that belong to the present.
B should include a note that readers are unlikely to skip.
C can convey experiences that historical records do not capture.
D are more reliable than people tend to assume.

20 Overall, what is Martin's attitude to historical novels?

A He values them, despite his reservations.
B He regards most of them as unreliable.
C He is mainly concerned about their commercial success.
D He prefers them to academic history.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por pregunta. Al corregir, 1 punto por acierto; los errores no restan. En el examen en papel se responde en el cuadernillo y al final hay 5 minutos para pasar las respuestas a la hoja.

Nº	A	B	C	D	Puntos
16	A	B	C	D	/ 1
17	A	B	C	D	/ 1
18	A	B	C	D	/ 1
19	A	B	C	D	/ 1
20	A	B	C	D	/ 1
				Total	**/ 5**

SOLUCIONES

1 punto por acierto. Primero la clave rápida; después, la transcripción completa con la frase que da cada respuesta en negrita y el número de la pregunta; por último, por qué la clave es correcta y por qué falla cada distractor, con su tipo (§4) y la cita que lo descarta. Los números de sección remiten a LST_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Tipo de pregunta	Distractores	Teoría
16	**B**	Propósito	A §4.6 · C §4.4 · D §4.8	§3.5 · §7.1
17	**A**	Detalle	B §4.2/4.4 · C §4.1 · D §4.8	§2.3 · §3.1
18	**B**	Actitud y opinión	A §4.2 · C §4.8 · D §4.4/4.1	§2.3 · §3.2 · §7.3
19	**C**	Acuerdo	A §4.4 · B §4.1/4.8 · D §4.8	§3.6 · §2.4 · §7.3
20	**A**	Global	B §4.5 · C §4.1/4.4 · D §4.5	§7.2 · §3.3 · §2.4

Transcripción

You will hear part of a radio programme in which the historian Martin Hale and the novelist Grace Okonjo discuss historical fiction.

Voces · Presenter: Emily, inglés irlandés · Martin: Mitchell, inglés neozelandés · Grace: Libby, inglés británico

Presenter Historical fiction has never sold better, but not everyone is delighted. Martin Hale is a historian of seventeenth-century England, and Grace Okonjo's novels are set in the same period. Martin, you've been fairly outspoken about all this.

Martin Have I? I suppose I have. Look, **I'm not one of those academics who think novelists should keep their hands off the past** [20]. But last year I had a letter from a woman who'd been to one of my lectures, and she was absolutely furious – not with a novelist, with me – because I'd said something that contradicted a scene in a bestseller she'd read. **She was quite sure the novel was right and I was wrong. That's the bit that bothers me.** [16] It isn't that novels invent things; of course they do. **It's that readers can't always tell where the inventing starts.** [16]

Presenter Grace, is that a fair worry?

Grace It's fair, yes, although I'd point out that history books get things wrong too, and they're read as gospel. Nobody writes furious letters about those. But I take Martin's point, and I'll make a confession. A reviewer – a historian, I should add – took me to task for having a character eat with a fork in sixteen twenty, when forks were still a rarity in England. **And the thing is, I knew.** [17] I'd read the same sources he had. **I left it in because the scene was about a woman** [17] trying to seem more sophisticated than she really was, and the fork did that in a single line. My editor wanted it changed for the paperback. I said no.

Martin And I have some sympathy with that, believe it or not. **What I'd ask is that novelists own up.** [18] A short note at the end – **this is what's documented, this is what I made up** [18]. It costs nothing, and it means a reader like my correspondent has somewhere to start. Some of the best novelists already do it, and nobody's ever told me it spoiled the story.

Grace I always include one. Although I'll be honest, I sometimes wonder who reads them. My publisher tells me they're the most skipped pages in the book.

Martin Well, I read them. Every word. It's usually the best part.

Grace	I'll choose to take that as a compliment.
Presenter	Grace, what can a novel do that a history book can't?
Grace	**It can tell you what it felt like.** [19] A historian can tell you the price of bread in sixteen thirty, and how many people died of plague in a given parish. What a historian generally can't tell you, because the evidence simply doesn't exist, is what it was like to lie awake at night listening for the cart that collected the bodies. **Fiction fills that silence.** [19] Responsibly, I hope, but it fills it.
Martin	**I'd go along with that, as far as it goes.** [19] The danger is that the silence gets filled with modern feelings – characters who just happen to share all our opinions about religion, or marriage, or what have you. Those are the books that really make me grind my teeth. A seventeenth-century heroine who thinks exactly like a modern newspaper columnist isn't a window on the past; she's a mirror. Not the forks.
Presenter	And yet you keep reading them.
Martin	I do. I came into this studio rather expecting to play the grumpy historian, and I suppose I have. **But I'd be lying if I said I hadn't learnt more about the texture of everyday life** [20] in the period from good novels than from half the books on my own shelves.

Explicaciones

16 · B · Propósito

Pregunta: Why does Martin mention the letter he received last year?

A to show how strongly some readers object to inaccurate novels
Falla (lógica alterada §4.6). Invierte la situación: la lectora no estaba furiosa con la novela, sino con él: not with a novelist, with me.

B to illustrate his concern that readers confuse fiction with fact
Correcta. La carta es un ejemplo al servicio de una idea (§3.5): la lectora creía la novela y no al historiador. Lo que le preocupa lo dice él mismo: That's the bit that bothers me. … It's that readers can't always tell where the inventing starts.

C to admit that he had been mistaken about a historical detail
Falla (voz equivocada §4.4). Que él se equivocaba es lo que pensaba la lectora (She was quite sure the novel was right and I was wrong), no algo que Martin admita.

D to suggest that novelists should consult historians more often
Falla (ausente §4.8). Es una conclusión razonable, pero Martin no la saca: lo que pide más tarde es una nota del autor, no que se consulte a los historiadores.

Teoría: §3.5 Función y propósito · §7.1 Part 3: la tarea

17 · A · Detalle

Pregunta: What does Grace reveal about the mistake a reviewer found in one of her novels?

A She had included it on purpose.
Correcta. La señal And the thing is (§2.3) anuncia la confesión: I knew. Conocía el dato y lo dejó por lo que aportaba a la escena: I left it in because the scene was about a woman que quería parecer más refinada.

B She corrected it when the book came out in paperback.
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2, voz equivocada §4.4). Es lo que quería su editor, y ella se negó: My editor wanted it changed for the paperback. I said no.

C It came from a source she should not have trusted.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1). Recoge sources, pero la frase dice lo contrario: había leído las mismas fuentes que el crítico (I'd read the same sources he had).

D She felt the reviewer had misunderstood the scene.
Falla (ausente §4.8). Explica para qué servía el tenedor, pero no reprocha nada al crítico: él tenía razón sobre el dato y ella lo reconoce.

Teoría: §2.3 Señales del discurso oral · §3.1 Lo que se dice y lo que se da a entender

18 · B · Actitud y opinión

Pregunta: What does Martin think novelists should do?

A avoid inventing events that are not recorded
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2). Lo descarta al principio: It isn't that novels invent things; of course they do.

B make clear which parts of their story are invented
Correcta. What I'd ask is that novelists own up. Y lo concreta: una nota final que diga this is what's documented, this is what I made up.

C ask historians to check their work before publication
Falla (ausente §4.8). Nadie propone que los historiadores revisen los manuscritos.

D remove any errors when their books are reprinted
Falla (voz equivocada §4.4, eco léxico §4.1). Corregir la edición de bolsillo era lo que quería el editor de Grace. Martin, en cambio, dice I have some sympathy with that: comprende que ella se negara.

Teoría: §2.3 Señales del discurso oral · §3.2 Voz propia y voces ajenas · §7.3 Seguir a dos voces

19 · C · Acuerdo

Pregunta: Grace and Martin agree that historical novels

A often give characters attitudes that belong to the present.
Falla (voz equivocada §4.4). Es el peligro que señala Martin (characters who just happen to share all our opinions). Grace no lo menciona, y often generaliza lo que él presenta como un riesgo.

B should include a note that readers are unlikely to skip.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1, ausente §4.8). Sale de the most skipped pages in the book: la nota existe, pero nadie dice que deba ser imposible de saltar.

C can convey experiences that historical records do not capture.
Correcta. Grace: la novela cuenta what it felt like, lo que las fuentes no recogen porque the evidence simply doesn't exist; Fiction fills that silence. Martin lo acepta (I'd go along with that, as far as it goes) y añade un riesgo, sin retirar el acuerdo. Su última intervención lo confirma: ha aprendido de las buenas novelas the texture of everyday life.

D are more reliable than people tend to assume.
Falla (ausente §4.8). Ninguno lo dice. Grace recuerda que también los libros de historia se equivocan, que es otra cosa.

Teoría: §3.6 Acuerdo y desacuerdo entre hablantes · §2.4 Matización · §7.3 Seguir a dos voces

20 · A · Global

Pregunta: Overall, what is Martin's attitude to historical novels?

A He values them, despite his reservations.
Correcta. Lo deja claro al principio (I'm not one of those academics who think novelists should keep their hands off the past) y al final, tras admitir que ha hecho de grumpy historian: But I'd be lying if I said I hadn't learnt more about the texture of everyday life con las buenas novelas. Las reservas (la confusión de los lectores, los sentimientos modernos) no anulan ese aprecio.

B He regards most of them as unreliable.
Falla (grado y alcance §4.5). Le irritan algunas (Those are the books that really make me grind my teeth), no la mayoría, y de las buenas dice que ha aprendido mucho.

C He is mainly concerned about their commercial success.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1, voz equivocada §4.4). Las ventas las menciona el presentador (Historical fiction has never sold better). A Martin no le preocupan.

D He prefers them to academic history.
Falla (grado y alcance §4.5). La comparación con half the books on my own shelves se limita a la vida cotidiana de la época; no prefiere la novela a la historia en general.

Teoría: §7.2 Part 3: método · §3.3 La segunda idea manda · §2.4 Matización